GRANDMA PROOF - ILLUSTRATED HANDOUT

VoiceMeeter Potato for Windows

Sound, sorted - one click at a time.

Every step gets its own page. Every page gets a picture.
Do not rush. Tick the green box before you turn the page.



LOOK: This is VoiceMeeter Potato. Yours will look like this. The names on yours may be a little different - that is normal.

You need: a Windows computer, headphones or speakers, a microphone, and about 20 minutes. Nothing else.

How to use this handout: One page = one job. Find the red circle in the picture. Click that spot on your computer. Then tick the green CHECK box. **New in this version:** when a step names a button, the picture now IS that button - cut out of the real screen, so it looks exactly like yours.

Official download: vb-audio.com - VoiceMeeter Potato page. Version in this handout: Voicemeeter 3.1.3.0 (ZIP package, 72.2 MB). Potato is donationware from VB-Audio Software.

BEFORE YOU CLICK ANYTHING

The one idea: a traffic controller for sound

Sound comes **IN** on the left. You press a button to say where it goes **OUT**. That is the whole program.

A

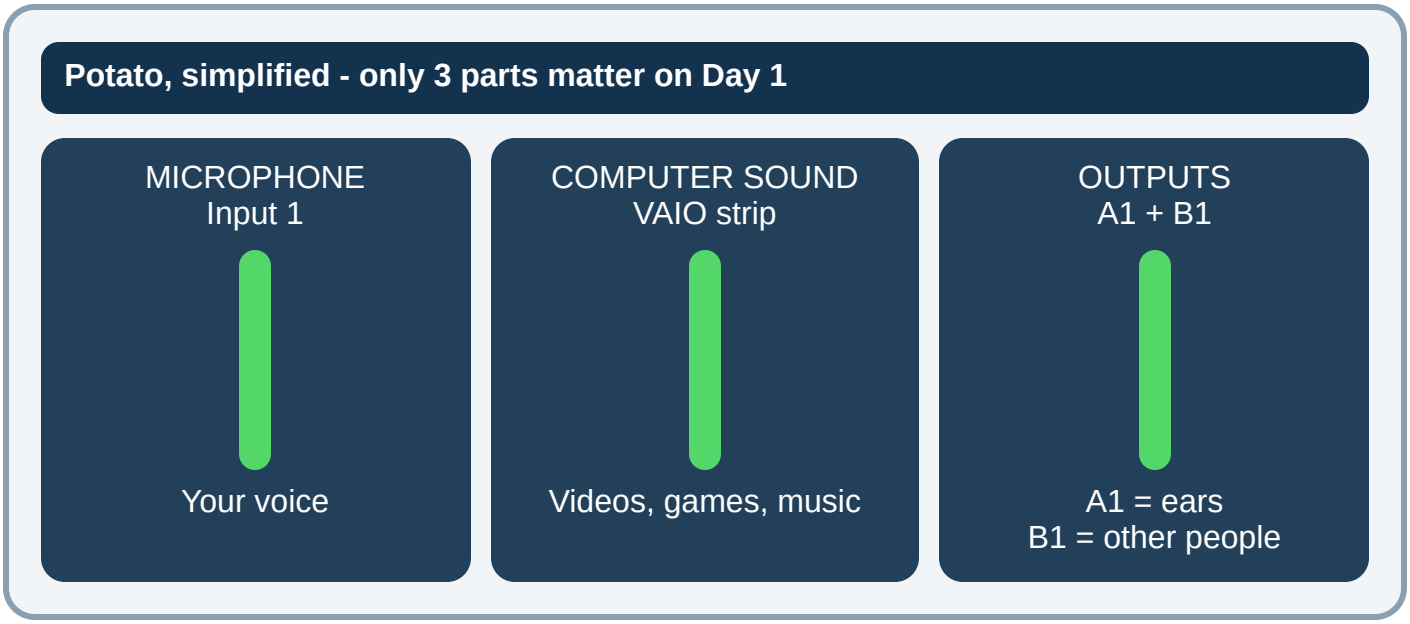
A = Actual ears

Sound for YOU.
Goes to your real headphones or speakers.

B

B = Broadcast

Sound for OTHER PEOPLE.
Discord, Zoom and OBS hear this.



Potato has 5 real inputs, 5 real outputs (A1-A5) and 3 pretend - virtual - ones (B1-B3). **Ignore the rest for now.** Beginners only need **Input 1, A1 and B1**.

CHECK: You can say it out loud - "A is for my ears. B is for other people." Then turn the page.

1

Download it - from the ONLY safe place

Go to **vb-audio.com** and open the **VoiceMeeter Potato** page.

vb-audio.com > VoiceMeeter Potato

1 **Click this ZIP file:**

Voicemeeter8Setup_v3130.zip
Voicemeeter 3.1.3.0 - 72.2 MB

That one file installs Potato. It also installs the smaller Banana and standard versions - you only open Potato.

STOP - never download it from anywhere else. Not FileHippo, not a random "free download" site. Only vb-audio.com.

CHECK: Look in your **Downloads** folder. Is the ZIP file there, about 72 MB? Tick this box and turn the page.

2

Install it - then RESTART

Three clicks to install. Then the most important click of all: Restart.

In your Downloads folder

1. Right-click the ZIP

Extract All

2. In the new folder, right-click the Setup program

Run as administrator

3. ! Click

INSTALL

DO NOT SKIP THE RESTART. When install finishes, restart the whole computer. VB-Audio says: run Setup as administrator and reboot after installation. Without the restart, the new sound devices do not appear - and Steps 5 and 6 cannot work.

CHECK: Your computer has restarted. Now turn the page - we prove it worked in Steps 5 and 6.

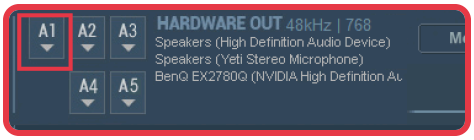
3

Tell Potato where your ears are: A1

Open **VoiceMeeter Potato** from the Start menu. Look at the **top-right corner**.



LOOK: Top-right says HARDWARE OUT. A1, A2, A3 sit above A4 and A5. Click A1.



REAL BUTTONS - cut out of the real Potato screen above. Click **A1**, inside the red box.

Click A1



This is A1, big.

Then pick your **headphones or speakers** from the list that drops down under A1.

If you see two versions of the same name, pick the one that starts with **WDM** - or **ASIO**, if you see it and you use a proper audio interface.

Set A1 FIRST, before anything else. Until A1 is set, you will hear nothing at all. This is the number 1 beginner panic - and now you know why.

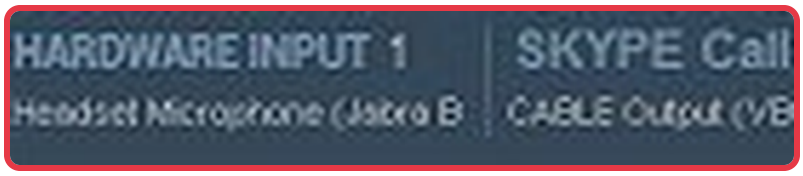
Do this once - so Potato starts by itself: click **Menu** (top-right corner) and turn ON **Run at Startup**. Now Potato is already open after every restart. If Potato is not open, there is no sound at all.

CHECK: The A1 button now shows the name of your headphones or speakers next to it.

4

Tell Potato where your voice is

Now the **top-left corner**. Click **Hardware Input 1** and pick your microphone.



REAL BUTTON AREA - the top of the first strip, cut out of the real screen. Click the name **HARDWARE INPUT 1**.

Pick **your microphone** from the list.

Two versions again?
Pick **WDM**.

Talk test

Green and yellow bars dance when you talk

Your microphone strip is the tall strip on the far left. When you talk, the coloured bars next to it should move up and down - engineers call that "dancing."

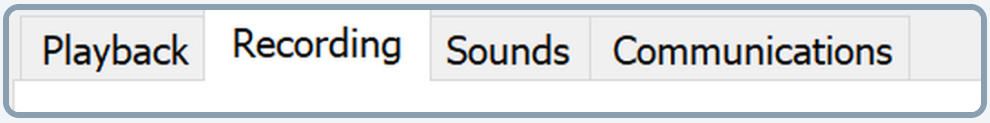
CHECK: Talk in a normal voice. Do the bars dance? Yes - turn the page. No - click Input 1 again and pick a different microphone from the list.

5

Make Potato the boss of ALL Windows sound - Part 1

Press the **Windows key + R** together. Type **mmsys.cpl** and press **Enter**. One old-style Sound box opens.

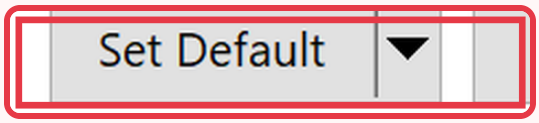
Sound box - Playback part



REAL TABS - cut out of the real Sound box. You are on **Playback** for this part.

Speakers
Realtek - your old default

1 **Voicemeeter Input**
VB-Audio Voicemeeter VAIO



Click this exact button below the list - the real one, cut out of the Sound box.

If a **Set Default Communication Device** choice appears, choose it for this same device too.

Why it looks backwards: Playback "Input" means sound goes **IN to Potato**. Backwards name, correct setting.

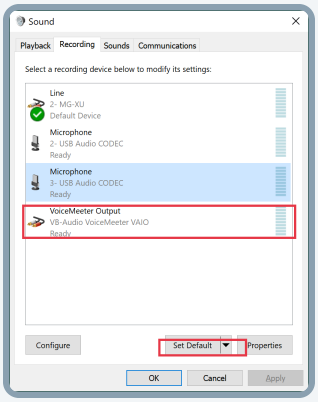
CHECK: A green tick now sits on **Voicemeeter Input (VB-Audio Voicemeeter VAIO)**. Stay in this same box - Part 2 is next.

5

Make Potato the boss - Part 2: Recording

Still in that same Sound box? Click the **Recording** tab at the top.

Sound box - Recording part (a real one)

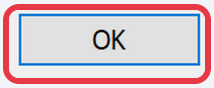


THE REAL SOUND BOX. Click the **VoiceMeeter Output** row (top red box), then **Set Default** (bottom red box). The other names came from the computer that took this picture - yours will be a little different, and that is fine.

Can't see Voicemeeter Output? Look for **Voicemeeter Out B1** - same thing, newer name.

One quick extra job before you close: click the **Communications** tab at the top of this same box and choose **Do nothing**. That stops Windows turning all your sound down in the middle of a Discord or Zoom call.

Now click this real **OK** button to close the box:



Backwards again - and still correct: Recording "Output" means sound comes **OUT of Potato** to your apps, so Discord and Zoom can hear you.

CHECK - the big test: Play any YouTube video. You can **hear it**, and the middle strip in Potato dances. Both? Windows is now Potato's. Turn the page.

6

The golden routing - set these buttons

Back in Potato. Every strip has small **A** and **B** buttons on its right side. Lit = ON. Dark = OFF. Set just these:

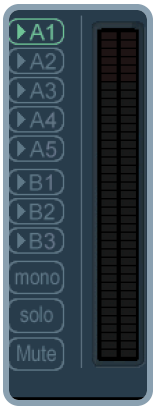
The only 2 strips you touch today - real buttons

YOUR MICROPHONE
Input 1



B1 is GREEN = ON
A1 is grey = OFF

COMPUTER SOUND
VAIO strip



A1 is GREEN = ON
B1 is grey = OFF*

* Turn computer B1 ON only when people on a call should also hear your videos or game. These are the real buttons, cut out of the screen - green means ON, grey means OFF.

Why mic A1 is OFF: A1 is your own ears. Mic to A1 means hearing your own voice back in your headphones. Nobody wants that. Mic to **B1** sends your voice to other people instead.

CHECK: Play a video - you hear it. Talk - the mic bars dance, but your voice is NOT in your headphones. Perfect. You are set up.

Way 1: Everything together

Use this on Day 1. It is what you already did in Step 5 - and for many people, it is enough forever.



Good for	Remember
Beginners, everyday listening, first calls	Windows default stays on Voicemeeter Input / Output - do not change it back

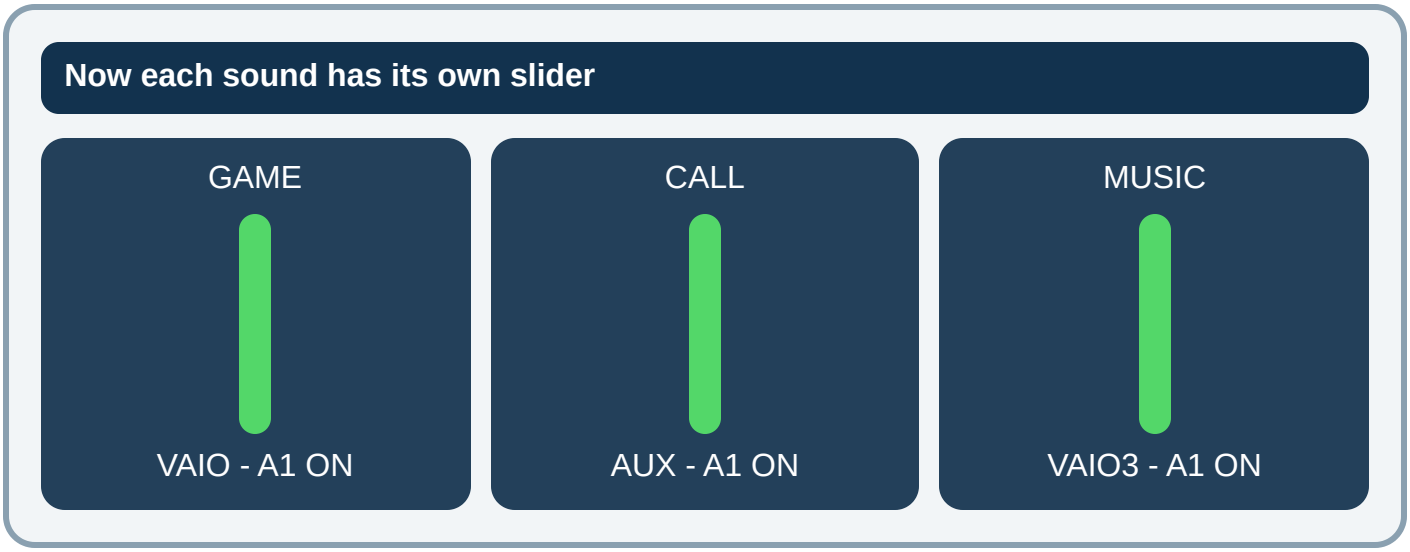
CHECK: Drag the VAIO strip slider in Potato. ALL computer sound gets quieter and louder together. That is Way 1 working.

Way 2: Split your apps in Windows

Use this in Week 2, when you want the game loud and Discord quiet - each on its own slider.

Open **Settings > System > Sound > Volume mixer**. Next to each app, choose where it sends its sound:

App	Send it to	Its strip in Potato
Game	Voicemeeter Input (VAIO)	VAIO strip
Discord / Zoom	Voicemeeter Aux Input	AUX strip
Music / Browser	Voicemeeter VAIO3 Input	VAIO3 strip



CHECK: Play music and a game at the same time. Move ONE strip slider. Only that one sound changes. That is Way 2 working.

Way 3: Set it inside the app itself

Use this for calls and recording. Leave Windows alone. Open the settings *inside* Discord, Zoom or OBS and set these two lines:

Inside Discord / Zoom / OBS - Audio settings

1. **Microphone / Input device**

   Voicemeeter Output (VB-Audio Voicemeeter VAIO)
   This is B1 - your voice, already mixed by Potato

2. **Speaker / Output device**

   Voicemeeter Aux Input (VB-Audio Voicemeeter AUX VAIO)
   Call sound lands on its own AUX strip, separate from your game

This keeps call sound on the AUX strip, so you can turn the call up or down without touching game or music volume.

Can't see Voicemeeter Output? Look for **Voicemeeter Out B1** - same thing, newer name.

CHECK: Join a test call. The other person hears you, you hear them, and their voice moves the AUX strip - not the VAIO strip.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

No sound? Check in THIS order

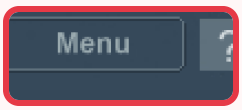
Do not jump around. Start at 1. Most problems die at 1, 2 or 3.

1 Is Potato actually open?
No Potato open = no sound at all. Open it from the Start menu and leave it open.

2 Is A1 picked, top-right?
A1 must show your headphones or speakers (Step 3).

3 Is A1 lit up on the strip that is playing?
Dark A1 button = that sound goes nowhere you can hear (Step 6).

4 Still stuck? Restart the engine, not the computer
In Potato, click this real **Menu** button in the top-right corner:



Then choose **Restart Audio Engine**. Then restart the app with no sound (Discord, OBS) - not the whole PC.

Hearing your own voice in your headphones? That is mic A1 switched ON by mistake. Turn mic A1 OFF, keep mic B1 ON (Step 6).

CHECK: Sound is back. Write down which number fixed it - that is your number next time too.

CUT OUT AND KEEP BY THE COMPUTER

Quick reference card

If you want...	Do this
Hear anything at all	Potato open + **A1** = your headphones (Step 3)
Be heard on a call	Mic = Input 1, **B1 ON, A1 OFF** (Steps 4 + 6)
Hear a video / game	VAIO strip, **A1 ON** (Step 6)
Share video sound on a call	VAIO strip, add **B1 ON** (Step 6)
Windows default	Playback: **Voicemeeter Input (VAIO)** Recording: **Voicemeeter Output (VAIO)**
App mic (Discord/Zoom/OBS)	**Voicemeeter Output** = microphone **Voicemeeter Aux Input** = speaker
Can't see Voicemeeter Output?	Look for **Voicemeeter Out B1** - same thing, newer name
No sound	Potato open? A1 picked? A1 lit? Restart Audio Engine

A

A = Actual ears - for you

B

B = Broadcast - for them

Version 3 - checked against the official manual. This handout has been error-checked against the official VoiceMeeter Potato User Manual (Voicemeeter 3.1.3.0, VB-Audio Software, vb-audio.com; ZIP package Voicemeeter8Setup_v3130.zip, 72.2 MB; install as administrator and reboot). Four fixes came from that check: (1) the newer name **Voicemeeter Out B1** means the same as Voicemeeter Output; (2) Step 3 now adds **Run at Startup**, so Potato opens by itself after every restart; (3) Step 5 now sets the **Communications** tab to **Do nothing**, so calls do not turn your sound down; (4) Step 3 now mentions **ASIO** as well as WDM for A1. Button pictures in this version: the A1 to A5 buttons, the strip A1 and B1 buttons, the Menu button, and the Windows Sound box with its Set Default and OK buttons are tight crops cut out of real screenshots, so they match what you see on screen. The download and install pictures (Steps 1 and 2) are still labelled diagrams, and a live run-through on a real Windows PC is still to come.

You did it. Potato is installed, Windows obeys it, your voice goes to B1 and your ears live on A1. That is a working setup - stamp it GrandMa Proof.